Medication Guide - Metformin

Metformin is a first-line medicine for type 2 diabetes. It lowers glucose production in the liver and improves insulin sensitivity.

Usual starting dose: 500 mg once daily with the evening meal, increased by 500 mg every week as tolerated. Maximum dose: 2000 mg per day.

Common side effects are nausea, diarrhoea and abdominal discomfort; taking the tablet with food reduces them. Long-term use can lower vitamin B12 levels.

Do not use metformin if eGFR is below 30 mL/min/1.73m2. Stop it temporarily before iodinated contrast imaging because of the risk of lactic acidosis.

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